

The GenZ Times

Where Generations Connect.

SEPTEMBER 2026 • ₹234

NOW, REDESIGN YOURSELF FOR THAT WORLD

THE SEPTEMBER 2026 FUTURE-READY EDITION

- THE TIME WE KILL, THE FUTURE WE LOSE
- YOUR STREAM IS NOT YOUR DESTINY
- THE NARROW SIDE OF THE HUMAN BRAIN

THE SEPTEMBER QUESTION

“If the world has changed, have you changed with it?”



**SAARADAA****LEARNOWATIONS**

Bringing the change you wish for

COMPREHENSIVE EDUCATIONAL ECO-SYSTEM (CEES)

Everything a school needs, under one roof.

THE SAARADAA ROOF**LEARN***What reaches the student***Research Oriented Material**

Evidence-led curriculum and workbooks designed with teachers, aligned to the syllabus and updated as classrooms change.

TEACH*What reaches the teacher***Faculty Development Program**

Structured training, mentoring and classroom observation so teachers keep growing long after their own degrees end.

MEASURE & LEAD*What the school can see and grow***Online Comprehensive Exam Portal**

Board-pattern mock examinations, auto-grading and instant analytics – chaos-free assessment for every grade.

English Enhancement Program

Listening, speaking, reading and writing workshops that turn hesitant students into confident, fluent communicators.

Guest Lectures Service

Experts, achievers and role models brought inside your school to show students what their subjects lead to in the real world.

Civil Services Aspirant Program

CSAP builds public-service awareness from Grade 6 – aptitude, reasoning and a calm roadmap, without the coaching panic.

Saaradaa's LMS

One learning platform built by educators: recorded classes, quizzes, worksheets and student progress on a single dashboard.

Student Ambassador Program

A leadership track that takes a student from trained to titled, building public speaking, representation and real responsibility.

Saaradaa Journal (SJIS)

A peer-style interdisciplinary journal that carries a student's idea all the way to a published, citable paper.

SL Radio - SchoolCast

A private, self-hosted school radio and communication network – live, on demand, on every phone, computer and browser.

YOU DO NOT HAVE TO TAKE ALL TEN**1 Start with one**

Whichever gap in your school is costing you most this year.

2 See it work

A term is long enough to know whether it has changed anything.

3 Add the next

Every service is built to connect to the ones already running.

CEES is not ten products bolted together. It is one connected system, built to work as a whole – and now shipping anywhere in India at store.thesipl.in.

Many publish books. We build futures.

+91 90301 70077 +91 90303 90077 www.thesipl.in | store.thesipl.in



THE GENZ TIMES

ISSUE 02 · SEPTEMBER 2026



EDITOR-IN-CHIEF

Ramesh Mamidala

CHIEF CONTENT OFFICER

Prathyusha Prabhala

DIGITAL EDITOR

Harsha Vardhan Mamidala

WRITERS

The Teaching Fraternity

DESIGN COORDINATOR

Karthik Kumar Kalamanda

COVER PAGE DESIGN

Prathyusha Prabhala

PHOTOGRAPHERS

SLPL Repository

SOCIAL MEDIA

Karthik Kumar Kalamanda,
Harsha Vardhan Mamidala

SALES & MARKETING

Uday Kiran Kavadi

HEAD OFFICE

2-3-472, First Floor, Rd No. 3, Sainagar Colony,
Hyderabad - 500068.

Printed and Published by Prathyusha Prabhala on
behalf of Saaradaa Learknowations Pvt. Ltd.



SCAN TO VISIT

www.theslpl.in
store.theslpl.in

· NAVIGATOR ·

COVER STORY & FEATURES

06

The Time We Kill, the Future We Lose

India's quiet epidemic of wasted hours, and what it really costs.

18

The Great Academic Crossover

Science to civics, law, finance, policy and public life.

20

When the Scientist Starts Studying Society

The signature career story of this issue.

45

The Narrow Side of the Human Brain

Is it getting narrower? What convenience is quietly doing to attention.

ALSO IN THIS ISSUE

05

Now, Redesign Yourself

The September editorial.

30

Your Stream Is Not Your Destiny

A direction, not a permanent label.

32

The Crossover Map

The centre spread: every route out of one marksheet.

39

Stop Choosing Careers for Your Children

Exposure before expectation.

61

Speaking Skills and Grooming

Soft skills: the part nobody teaches, made simple.

FOR MORE FROM SAARADAA

Read, shop and learn online: www.theslpl.in | store.theslpl.in | The GenZ
Times is your platform - write to editor@saaradaa.com.



SAARADAA

LEARNOWATIONS

Bringing the change you wish for

SL RADIO · SCHOOLCAST

Your school has something to say.

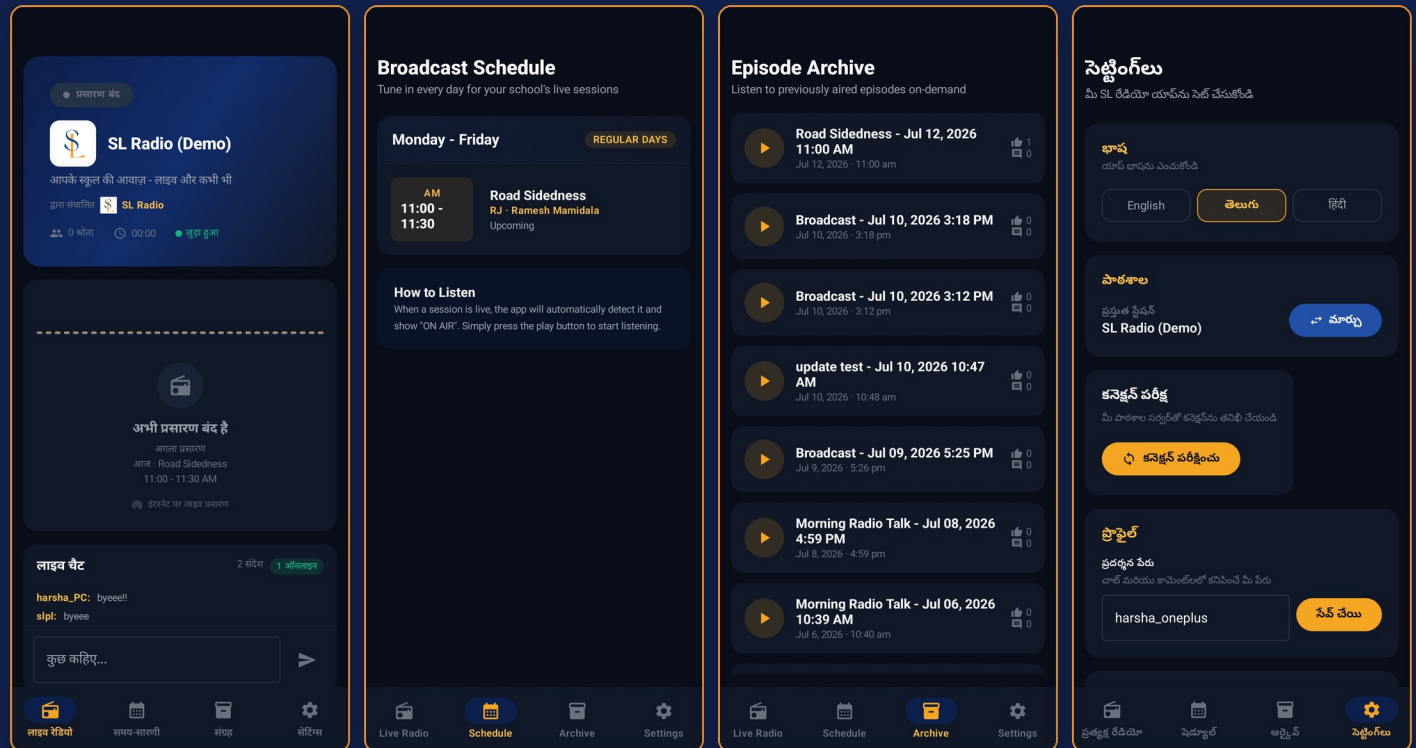
A private internet radio station your school owns outright. A student speaks into a microphone and the whole community hears it live – on any phone, any computer, any browser.



PAALA PITTA

THE VOICE OF SL RADIO · YOUR SCHOOL, ON AIR

Named for the roller that calls across every field in Telangana.



Live, with the school's own chat alongside it.

The week's schedule, on every phone at once.

Every broadcast archived and replayable for a week.

Fully translated – English, Telugu and Hindi.

WHAT MAKES IT DIFFERENT

- ✓ Private by default – closed to your school by an access code
- ✓ Every broadcast recorded automatically and kept for a week
- ✓ English, Telugu and Hindi – every screen, not just the menus
- ✓ Self-hosted on your own machine. No advertisements, no per-student fee

Put your school on air · +91 90303 90077

Many publish books. We build futures.

+91 90301 70077 +91 90303 90077 www.theslpl.in | store.theslpl.in

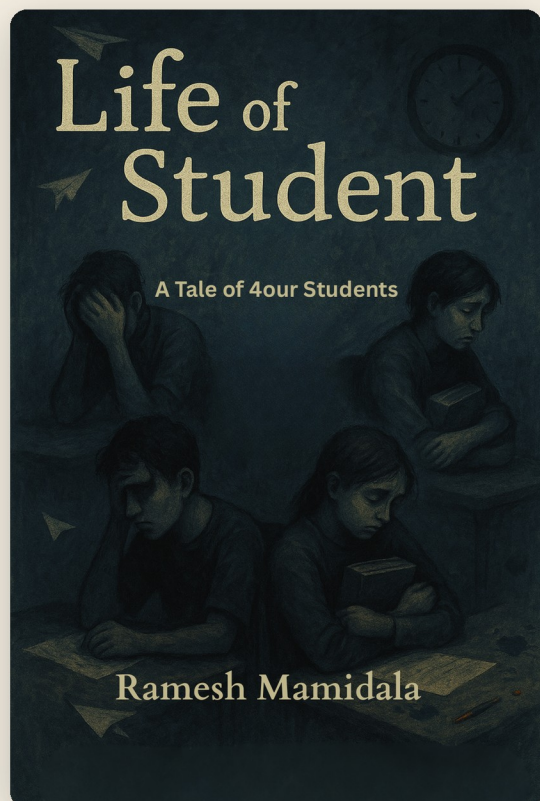


SAARADAA
LEARKNOWATIONS

Bringing the change you wish for

FROM THE SAARADAA BOOKSHELF · A NOVEL

Life of Student



A Tale of 4our Students.

Drawn from two decades of teaching and mentoring - from counselling rooms echoing with unspoken fears to classrooms that thirst for creativity - this is more than fiction. It is a mirror, a movement and a manifesto for every learner burdened by a system that demands scores but silences questions.

Ramesh Mamidala

A compassionate educator and evocative writer whose work gives voice to the silent and untold dreams of Indian students.

- Novel · Saaradaa Learknowations
- Language: English
- ₹396
- In stock, delivered across India

ORDER IT



Scan to buy, or go to
store.theslpl.in/product/life-of-student

Free delivery across India from the Saaradaa store.

Order Life of Student · store.theslpl.in

Many publish books. We build futures.

+91 90301 70077 +91 90303 90077 www.theslpl.in | store.theslpl.in



02

THE BIG CAREER SHIFT

The Great Academic Crossover

A science education was never a narrowing. It is one of the widest preparations available for law, economics, governance, finance and public life - and almost nobody tells a sixteen-year-old so.





SAARADAA

LEARKNOWATIONS

Bringing the change you wish for

POETRY · FROM THE SAARADAA BOOKSHELF

Pusthakavilapam



The lament of books.

Not just a story: a mirror held up to our society, and a quiet anguish over the reading habits we are losing. A Telugu work that asks what happens to us when books fall silent, and gently calls its readers back to them.

Ramesh Mamidala

సాారాదా లీర్నోవేషన్స్ · from the SLPL publishing house.

- Poetry · Saaradaa Learknowations
- Language: Telugu
- ₹153 (MRP ₹180, 15% off)
- In stock, delivered across India

ORDER IT



Scan to buy, or go to
store.theslpl.in/product/pusthakavilapam

Free delivery across India from the Saaradaa store.

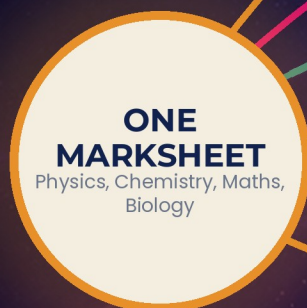
Order Pusthakavilapam · store.theslpl.in

Many publish books. We build futures.

+91 90301 70077 +91 90303 90077 www.theslpl.in | store.theslpl.in

Your Stream Is Not Your Destiny

One marksheet, and every route that leads out of it. None of these is a second choice, and none of them requires starting again.



WHAT TRAVELS WITH YOU, WHICHEVER ROUTE

- Reading something difficult and getting out of it exactly what it says
- Reasoning with numbers without being frightened of them
- Writing a claim, the reason for it, and the evidence, in that order
- Attempting a problem nobody has shown you how to solve



CIVIL SERVICES

UPSC, and the state Groups

Polity, economy, ethics. The aptitude paper is comprehension and reasoning – both already yours.

LAW

CLAT, and the national law schools

Logical reasoning and reading under time. A science student arrives already trained in the first half.

FINANCE & ACCOUNTS

CA, CFA, actuarial work

Quantitative aptitude, standards written in exact language, and the patience to read them properly.

PUBLIC POLICY

Economics, governance, think tanks

Evidence, models and trade-offs. The method is the one you learned in a laboratory.

DATA & TECHNOLOGY

Analytics, engineering, research

The straight continuation – but now with the argument about what the number means attached.

RESEARCH & TEACHING

Fellowships, the university, the school

The route that makes every other route possible, and the one nobody is told about.



03

PARENTS, SCHOOLS & THE MACHINE

Redesign Is Not Only for Students

If a child's stream is not her destiny, then a parent choosing it is making a smaller decision than they think - and a school built around two entrance examinations is preparing students for a narrower world than the one waiting.

PSYCHOLOGY

The Narrow Side of the Human Brain! Is it Getting Narrower?

The brain keeps what it uses and quietly gives up what it does not. That is good news, until you look at what a modern day actually asks it to practise.

BY THE GENZ TIMES EDITORIAL
DESK

The human brain is not a container that fills up. It is closer to a landscape that is worn into shape by traffic. Paths used daily become wide and fast. Paths left alone grow over. Neuroscientists call this plasticity, and it is usually introduced to students as encouraging news, because it means nobody is finished at sixteen.

It is encouraging. It is also the reason for a question worth taking seriously. If the brain widens whatever it is asked to do repeatedly, then it narrows around whatever it is not. And a modern day asks a young person to practise a startlingly small number of things, over and over, at enormous frequency.

WHAT NARROWING ACTUALLY MEANS

Not that anyone is becoming less intelligent. Measured intelligence is not falling and this article is not that argument. Narrowing is a different and more specific claim: that the RANGE a mind moves comfortably through is contracting, even while its speed inside that range increases.

It shows in three places. The span of attention a person can hold without reaching for relief. The range of opinion they regularly encounter rather than hear described. And the set of things they are willing to be visibly bad at long enough to become competent. Each of these has narrowed for reasons that are individually reasonable.

“Nobody is becoming less intelligent. The range a mind moves through is contracting, while its speed inside that range goes up.”

GENZ TIMES EDITORIAL DESK

WHY CONVENIENCE DOES THE DAMAGE

Almost every narrowing force of the last decade arrived disguised as help. Recommendation systems remove the trouble of finding something you will like, and remove with it the accident of meeting something you would not have chosen. Search removes the need to hold a fact, and the holding was never the point - except that facts held in a head are the raw material thinking works on, and facts on a screen are not.

Short-form video removes the wait before the interesting part. Nothing about any of this is sinister. Each is a genuine improvement taken on its own. The difficulty is that all of them remove friction, friction is what the brain was widening itself against, and a landscape with no hills produces a body that cannot climb.

THE THREE NARROWINGS

- Attention: how long you can stay with one thing before reaching for relief.
- Exposure: how much you meet that you did not already agree with.
- Tolerance: how long you will stay visibly bad at something new.
- All three widen with use and contract with disuse. Neither is permanent.

THE EVIDENCE A STUDENT CAN CHECK

The research most often quoted here concerns London taxi drivers, who spend years memorising a vast street network and show measurable structural change in the region of the brain associated with spatial memory. The finding is striking, but the useful half is the ordinary half: whatever they practised grew, and nothing they did not practise grew on its own.

A student can run a smaller version of this experiment without a laboratory.

Try to read forty pages in one sitting. Try to recall seven phone numbers. Try to sit for twenty minutes with nothing in your hands. The discomfort that arrives is not a character flaw and it is not permanent. It is a measurement, and it is information about which paths have grown over.

WIDENING, DELIBERATELY

The correction is not abstinence, which nobody sustains. It is deliberate difficulty in small quantities: one long thing a week that cannot be skimmed, one argument a month from somebody you find wrong, one skill a year attempted in public while still bad at it. Each is uncomfortable in exactly the way that indicates it is working.

None of this requires a school to change its timetable, though it helps when one does. It requires a student to notice that a brain shaped entirely by the easiest available option will be extremely good at taking the easiest available option, and that this is a poor description of any life worth planning for.

WHAT A SCHOOL CAN DO ABOUT IT

Very little that requires money, and a great deal that requires nerve. Protect one period a week in which nothing is covered and something long is read. Set one task a term with no method attached, so that being stuck is a normal classroom condition rather than evidence of failure. Ask, occasionally, for an argument against the position the class has just been taught.

Each of these is uncomfortable for a teacher under syllabus pressure, and each is the only kind of practice that widens rather than deepens.

The brain is not getting narrower by itself. It is doing what it has always done, specialising in whatever it is handed. What has changed is what we hand it.



SAARADAA
LEARNOWATIONS

Bringing the change you wish for

ENGLISH COMMUNICATION WORKSHOPS • IN YOUR SCHOOL

Speak. Read. Write. Listen.

Master them all.

The Advanced English Program builds complete LSRW mastery – from classroom confidence to competitive examinations – delivered inside your school, by educators who teach it every week.



A workshop in progress: every section of a grade, in the school's own hall, in a single sitting.



Students present to their own class – the part most never get to practise.



Speaking on the microphone, unscripted, at Vignan Model High School.



Alpha High School, Hyderabad: a full hall, one morning, no extra staff.

Listening

Audio-based activities that sharpen comprehension and attention.

Speaking

Stage-ready confidence through practice, debate and presentation.

Reading

Comprehension that analyses, infers and thinks critically.

Writing

Clear, structured expression for examinations and the real world.

WHAT A STUDENT LEAVES WITH

- ✓ Textual grammar aligned to board examination patterns
- ✓ Olympiad-level English readiness and preparation
- ✓ The confidence to stand up and be heard – the part marks never measure

Book a workshop for your school • +91 90301 70077

Many publish books. We build futures.

+91 90301 70077 +91 90303 90077 www.theslpl.in | store.theslpl.in

**SAARADAA****LEARNOWATIONS**

Bringing the change you wish for

FACULTY DEVELOPMENT PROGRAMME • FOR SCHOOLS

Great teachers never stop learning.

Professional growth workshops that bring new-age pedagogy into every classroom – structured, practical, and immediately usable on the Monday after.

WHAT A SAARADAA FDP DAY LOOKS LIKE

- 1 Diagnose**
Understand your faculty's current methods and challenges.
- 2 Demonstrate**
Experts model new-age pedagogy with live examples.
- 3 Practise**
Teachers apply the techniques hands-on, with feedback.
- 4 Certify**
Every participant leaves with recognition and a toolkit.

FOUR WAYS WE GROW YOUR FACULTY

- Pedagogy**
Modern methods that keep every kind of learner engaged.
- Digital tools**
LMS platforms and smart-class integration that get used.
- Assessment**
Better questions, fairer grading, clearer feedback.
- Mentorship**
Ongoing support long after the workshop ends.



WHAT YOUR FACULTY TAKES AWAY

- ✓ New-age pedagogy and modern teaching methods
- ✓ Technology tools that actually work in Indian classrooms
- ✓ Assessment design and question-crafting workshops
- ✓ Certification and a professional growth pathway for every educator

Schedule an FDP • +91 90301 70077*Many publish books. We build futures.*+91 90301 70077 +91 90303 90077 www.theslpl.in | store.theslpl.in

The GenZ Times

Where Generations Connect.

SEPTEMBER 2026 · NOW, REDESIGN YOURSELF FOR THAT WORLD



“If the world has changed, have you changed with it?”

WHAT IS IN THIS ISSUE

THE GEN Z MIND

Time, attention, systems and the courage to be bored.

THE GREAT ACADEMIC CROSSOVER

Science to civics, law, finance, policy and public life.

PARENTS, SCHOOLS & THE MACHINE

Coaching, exposure, and what a school should measure.

CHARACTER & CITIZENSHIP

From spectator to citizen, and failure as feedback.

SOFT SKILLS

Speaking, grooming, and reading as the master road.

IN THE NEXT ISSUE

A school profile from Abdullapurmet, the psychology of motivation, and the second half of the crossover: what happens after the stream change.

EVERY BACK ISSUE



Read, shop and subscribe: www.theslpl.in store.theslpl.in

THE GENZ TIMES IS YOUR PLATFORM

Write to us, argue with us, and send us what you have been working on. Letters, essays and school submissions: editor@saaradaa.com.



THE GENZ TIMES · Saaradaa Learknowations Pvt. Ltd.

+91 90301 70077 · www.theslpl.in | store.theslpl.in

2-3-472, First Floor, Rd No. 3, Sainagar Colony, Hyderabad - 500068.